Tarana Chauhan

Centre for Philosophy, Politics and Economics, Brown University
25, George St. Office 301, Providence (RI), U.S.A. 02906
tarana_chauhan@brown.edu taranachauhan.com /in/taranachauhan

References:

Christopher B. Barrett	Brian M. Dillon	Andrew Foster
Cornell University	Cornell University	Brown University
cbb2@cornell.edu	bmd28@cornell.edu	andrew_foster@brown.edu

Employment

Brown University — Providence (RI), USA
Postdoctoral Research Associate — 2024 -

Education

Cornell University — Ithaca (NY), USA
Ph.D. Applied Economics and Management — 2024
Dissertation - Essays on Financial Inclusion, Extreme Weather Events and Development
M.Sc. Applied Economics and Management — 2022

Tata Institute of Social Sciences — Mumbai, India
M.A. Development Studies — 2016
Dissertation - Government Regulations in the Intermediate Public Transport sector: Study of a Metropolitan City

University of Delhi — New Delhi, India
B.A. Economics — 2014

Fields

Applied Microeconomics (Development, Labor, Gender); Political economy

Job market Paper

Agricultural Credit and Women's Agency: Experimental Evidence from India
(with Berber Kramer, Patrick Ward and Subhransu Pattnaik)
Women-focused programs raising income and agency are costly and difficult to implement, and evaluations show that targeted cash transfers and loans are often appropriated into assets and enterprises outside women's control. We hypothesize that improving liquidity constraints for households increases household consumption and residual income for individual members, and evaluate its consequences for women. We test this using randomized provision of collateral-free loans for farming across 80 villages in India. Employing IV estimations, we find that women in loan-receiving households report independent access to banking services through debit cards and mobile phones, and allocate more time towards leisure. Households increase ownership of productive capital and consumer durables in response to the program but there are no impacts on agricultural productivity or income. The findings suggest that agricultural credit programs can serve as an effective and cost-efficient tool to improve women's outcomes, even when not directly targeted at them.

Publication

Raghunathan, K., Kumar, N., Gupta, S., **Chauhan, T.**, Kohli, A. and Menon, P. (2023). "Learning together: Experimental evidence on the impact of group-based nutrition interventions in rural Bihar". *World Development*, 168: 106267.

Working Papers

Chauhan, T. (2025). Accounting for Empowerment? Examining Women's Financial Inclusion in India, *GLO Discussion Paper*, No. 1689, Global Labor Organization (GLO), Essen.

Women's Agency and Intra-Household Efficiency (2025) with Carolina Castilla & David Murphy

Chauhan, T. (2023). Extreme Temperature and Intimate Partner Violence (IPV): Evidence from Sub-Saharan Africa

Chauhan, T. (2022). Political incentives and flood recovery in India

In progress

"**Worker sorting and retention in Indian manufacturing**" with Natasha Jha

Currently implementing Lab-in-Field experiment with 600 migrant workers to study worker evaluation during hiring, measure misallocation and explain high attrition in Haryana, India

Teaching experience

Instructor (Brown University) Spring 2026, 2025

ECON 1330: Gender and Development

- Teach application of quantitative methods such as Difference-in-Differences (DiD), Event Study, Regression Discontinuity (RD), Synthetic Controls (SC) and Shift-share and Instrumental Variables (IV) estimation to study issues of gender inequality
- Evaluation: Quantitative problem set, exam and research paper
- Software: R, STATA and Python

Co-instructor and Teaching Assistant (Cornell University)

Summer 2024, 2023 & 2020; Fall 2021 & 2020

AEM 2350: Introduction to the Economics of Development

- Taught students use of macroeconomic datasets and writing a short research paper
- Weekly lectures or discussion sections covering topics of micro and macroeconomic theory and international trade; ; evaluation of problem sets, exam & research paper

Course Assistant (Cornell University) Spring 2024

AEM 6480: Food and Consumer Packaged Goods Industry Dynamics

Visiting lecturer (Colgate University) Fall 2023

ECON 443: Seminar in Policy Evaluation

- Lectures on Synthetic Controls, replication exercises and feedback on research papers

Guest Lecturer and Teaching Assistant (Cornell University) Fall 2023

AEM 2600: Managerial Economics

- Lecture on intermediate microeconomic theory; evaluation of problem sets & exams

Teaching assistant (Cornell University) Spring 2022, Fall 2019

AEM 4140: Behavioural Economics and Managerial Decisions

- Conducted weekly lab experiments with students and evaluations

Past Employment

Senior Research Analyst 1, International Food Policy Research Institute (IFPRI) 2016-18

Consultant, Population Council Summer 2016

	Research Assistant, Centre for Policy Research	Winter 2014
	Research Assistant, (Former) Planning Commission of India	Summer 2013
	Research Assistant, The Energy and Resources Institute (TERI)	Winter 2011

Other research experience	Research Assistant for Carolina Castilla, Colgate University	2021-22
	Visiting Research Fellow, Centre for Monitoring Indian Economy (CMIE)	2021
	Research Assistant for Christopher B. Barrett and Katie Fiorella, Cornell University	2020
	Graduate Research Assistant for Brian M. Dillon, Cornell University	2020
	Research Assistant for Vrinda Kadiyali, Cornell University	2019

Awards & Fellowships	BIG Lab Mezzanine Grant (University of Notre Dame), USD 14, 560 (co-PI)	2025
	Amit Bhatia'01 Global PhD Research Scholar: Grant for International Field Research (Cornell University), USD 10,000 (PI)	2022-23
	Cornell University Fellowship	Fall 2022
	GRA Fellowship (Cornell University)	2018, 2023
	Adlerbert Graduate Assistantship	Summer 2021, 2022

Invited Talks	Providence College	2026
	Lee Kuan Yew School of Public Policy, National University of Singapore	2025
	Kania School of Management, University of Scranton	2024
	Colgate-Hamilton Economics Seminar, Colgate University	2023
	Economics Department Research Seminar, Lafayette College	2023

Conference Presentations

2025	Global Labor Organization JOPE Bonn
2024	North East Universities Development Consortium (Northeastern University); 19th Annual Conference on Economic Growth and Development (Indian Statistical Institute Delhi); Third Biennial Conference on Development (Indira Gandhi Institute of Development Research); Eastern Economic Association Annual Conference
2023	European Winter Meeting of the Econometric Society (University of Manchester); Researcher Gathering hosted by Innovations for Poverty Action and Global Poverty Research Lab (Northwestern University); Agricultural & Applied Economics Association (AAEA) Annual Meeting Washington D.C.
2022	100 Years of Economic Development (Cornell University); International Fund for Agricultural Development (IFAD) International Conference Rome; AAEA Annual Meeting Anaheim; CSAE Conference on Economic Development in Africa; Pacific Conference for Development Economics (University of San Francisco)
2021	European Economic Association - Econometric Society European Meeting; Western Agricultural Economics Association Joint Annual Meeting; International Conference in Development Economics (University of Bordeaux)

Academic Service

Refereeing

Journal of Development Economics; Journal of Population Economics; Review of Economics of the Household; Eastern Economic Journal; Australian Journal of Agricultural and Resource Economics; Economics of Education Review; Review of Social Economy

Peer review of grant proposal

BRAC Institute of Governance and Development (BIGD) Women's Economic Empowerment and Digital Finance

Mentoring

Research Assistants, Brown University

Megan Ball 2025

Yaxuan Shi (First placement - Altman Solon, Boston) 2024

Structural Transformation of African and Asian Agriculture and Rural Spaces (STAAARS+) Fellows Program 2022-23

Peer mentor for Post Doctoral Research Fellows at the Nigerian Institute of Social and Economic Research

Faculty adviser: David Stifel, Lafayette College

Peer Mentor for Undergraduate students, University of Delhi 2022

Mentored research study improving women's menstrual hygiene in India

Faculty adviser: Christopher B. Barrett, Cornell University

Reading Group for undergraduate students in India Spring 2023

Organized discussions on papers covering finance, industrial organization, health, gender and development topics

Seminars promoting Diversity, Equity and Inclusion

Panelist, "Application and experience of post-graduation in the US": Attended by over 200 students from University of Delhi February 2023

Organizer, "Seminar culture in Economics": Panel discussion of female faculty and graduate students in Economics at Cornell University September 2021

Selected Workshops

GLO Virtual Young Scholars Program (GLO VirtYS) 2023-24

Mentor: José Alberto Molina, University of Zaragoza

Association for Mentoring and Inclusion in Economics (AMIE) 2023-24

Mentors: Upasak Das, University of Manchester and Lelys Dinarte Diaz, The World Bank

Everyday Adaptations to Climate Change Workshop, Sustainability and Development Initiative (University of Michigan) 2021

Mentor: Arun Agrawal, University of Michigan

Successfully Navigating Economics PhD (CSWEP American Economic Association) 2020

Mentors: Victoria Baranov, University of Melbourne and Sarojini Hirshleifer, University of California Riverside

Women in Economics (Boston University) 2020

Mentor: Pinar Keskin, Wellesley College

Skills

Analytical and Quantitative

Randomized Control Trials (RCT), Lab-in-Field experiments, Difference-in-Differences (DiD), Regression Discontinuity Spatial Analysis, Synthetic Controls, Regularization, Cross-validation, Fairness testing

Programs & Tools

Python, R, STATA, QGIS, Google Earth Engine, Javascript, MATLAB, SurveyCTO, ODK, CSPro, Jupyter, Git, Microsoft Suite

Training Certifications

Survey Design and Experimental Methods in Applied and Agricultural Economics (Arizona State University) 2021, 2020

Other

Languages: English (fluent), Hindi (native), French (beginner)

Citizenship: Indian